

10

Averbakh and Makogonov Systems

Answer Bg5, h3, and g4 setups with flexible counterplay



THIS VOLUME

6

deep lessons

12

lesson positions

30

course pages

Learn why White delays standard development and how Black should avoid premature attacks.

LEARN THE STRUCTURE, THEN THE LINE

A four-pass method for a theory-heavy opening

1. DECODE THE POSITION

Read the board before the moves. Name the center, each side's break, the worst piece, the king-safety difference, and the race clock.

2. UNDERSTAND THE CAUSAL CHAIN

Every recommendation connects a cue to a reason and a consequence. If you know only the move, you do not yet know the opening.

3. PLAY THE DECISION

Generate Black's candidates, find White's strongest reply, and choose the resulting structure you understand. The move is the end of the reasoning, not the beginning.

4. RETRIEVE UNDER PRESSURE

Cover the answer key, reconstruct the line, and speak the memory rule. Review after 1, 3, 7, 14, and 30 days, then test the idea in a slow game.

THEORY WARNING

This is a durable concept-first repertoire, not a claim to be a live engine database. Before tournament use, verify sharp forcing branches in Fritz or a current database.

Priority order at the board: legality and tactical survival, king safety, forcing moves, central transformation, activity, structure, then the remembered rule.

SIX LINKED LESSONS

Recognition first, execution second

LESSON 055 | PAGE 4

Decode: The Averbakh bishop*When one break is restrained, test the other break immediately.*

LESSON 056 | PAGE 8

Play: The Averbakh bishop*When one break is restrained, test the other break immediately.*

LESSON 057 | PAGE 12

Decode: Makogonov's h3 and g4*Attack the base of the space, not the visible tip.*

LESSON 058 | PAGE 16

Play: Makogonov's h3 and g4*Attack the base of the space, not the visible tip.*

LESSON 059 | PAGE 20

Decode: The restrained classical center*A prevented maneuver is information: choose a different route.*

LESSON 060 | PAGE 24

Play: The restrained classical center*A prevented maneuver is information: choose a different route.***VOLUME OBJECTIVE**

Learn why White delays standard development and how Black should avoid premature attacks.

DECODE PASS | STRUCTURAL DECISION POINT

Decode: The Averbakh bishop

**WHY THIS POSITION MATTERS**

Bg5 restrains easy ...e5 and can discourage ...f5, so Black strikes with ...c5 before White consolidates.

DECISION RULE

Decide whether the center should be opened before White castles.

SIDE TO MOVE

White

BLACK'S JOB

Challenge d4 and d5, use the e-file, and develop the queen knight according to the structure.

WHITE'S COUNTERPLAY

White wants Qd2, h4, and a stable space advantage.

MEMORY RULE | When one break is restrained, test the other break immediately.

CUE -> REASON -> MOVE -> REPLY -> NEW POSITION

The plan map



CUE

Bg5 restrains easy ...e5 and can discourage ...f5, so Black strikes with ...c5 before White consolidates.

BLACK AIMS FOR

Challenge d4 and d5, use the e-file, and develop the queen knight according to the structure.

FINAL SIDE TO MOVE

Black

WHITE'S BEST PRACTICAL IDEA

White wants Qd2, h4, and a stable space advantage.

FAILURE MODE

A slow setup lets White complete development with every strategic question answered.

DECISION TEST

Ask: Decide whether the center should be opened before White castles. Then compare at least two candidates against White's strongest forcing reply. Choose the endpoint whose center, king safety, and piece jobs you can explain.

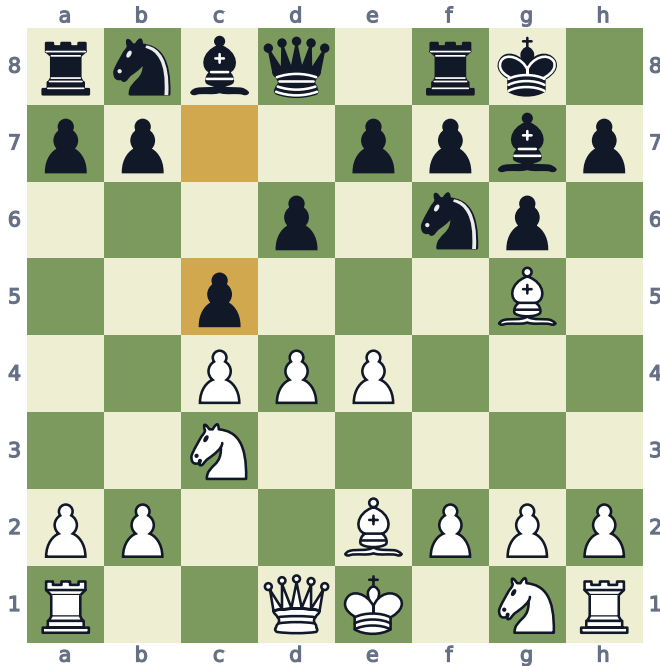
RULE | When one break is restrained, test the other break immediately.

INSTRUCTIVE REFERENCE LINE - NOT A PROMISE OF FORCED BEST PLAY

Move-by-move meaning

REFERENCE LINE

1. d4 Nf6 2. c4 g6 3. Nc3 Bg7 4. e4 d6 5. Be2 O-O 6. Bg5 c5 7. d5 e6 8. Qd2 exd5 9. exd5



- e4: White changes the pawn skeleton; reassess breaks, open lines, and weakened squares.
- d6: Black changes the pawn skeleton; reassess breaks, open lines, and weakened squares.
- Be2: White changes a bishop's diagonal and the balance between development, pressure, and tempo.
- O-O: Black secures the king and activates a rook; the central decision can now become concrete.
- Bg5: White changes a bishop's diagonal and the balance between development, pressure, and tempo.
- c5: Black attacks the center from the flank and invites a Benoni-like transformation.

WHAT THE LINE TEACHES

Bg5 restrains easy ...e5 and can discourage ...f5, so Black strikes with ...c5 before White consolidates.

WHAT MUST BE CALCULATED

Decide whether the center should be opened before White castles. White's resistance is: White wants Qd2, h4, and a stable space advantage. The line fails as a template when: A slow setup lets White complete development with every strategic question answered.

STORE THIS | When one break is restrained, test the other break immediately.

COVER THE ANSWER KEY AND SPEAK EACH ANSWER

Retrieval and self-coaching

1. What center or structural transition defines this position?

2. What is Black's primary plan, and which piece or pawn enables it?

3. What is White's fastest or most forcing counterplay?

4. What exact question decides the next move?

5. What is the most dangerous way to misuse the remembered plan?

ANSWER KEY

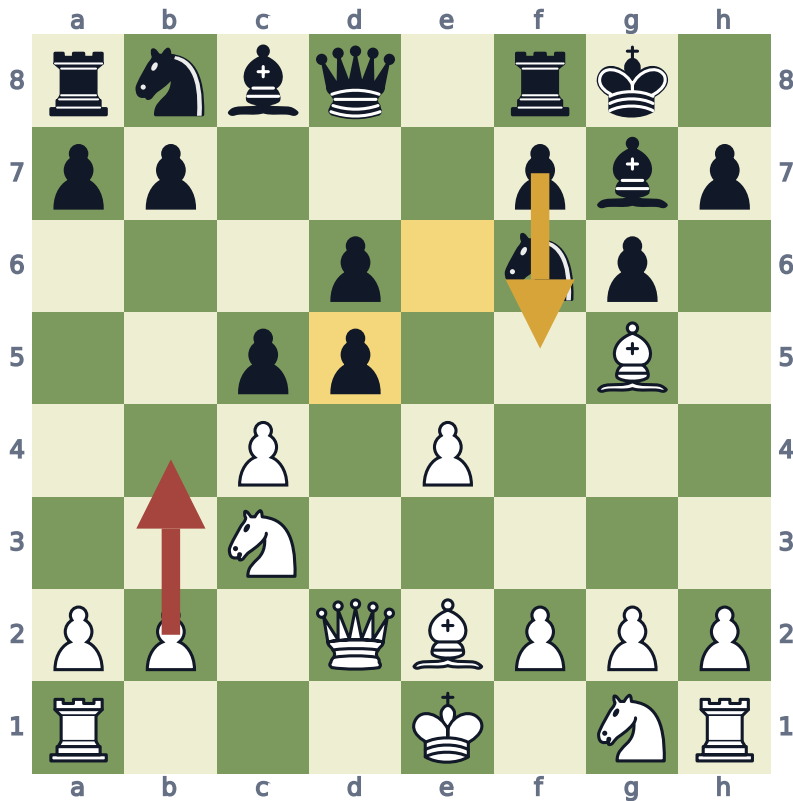
1. Bg5 restrains easy ...e5 and can discourage ...f5, so Black strikes with ...c5 before White consolidates. 2. Challenge d4 and d5, use the e-file, and develop the queen knight according to the structure. 3. White wants Qd2, h4, and a stable space advantage. 4. Decide whether the center should be opened before White castles. 5. A slow setup lets White complete development with every strategic question answered.

BOARD RECONSTRUCTION

Rebuild the position after 12 plies from memory, then replay: 4. e4 d6 5. Be2 O-O 6. Bg5 c5

PLAY PASS | PLAN EXECUTION AND TACTICAL CONTACT

Play: The Averbakh bishop

**WHY THIS POSITION MATTERS**

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SIDE TO MOVE

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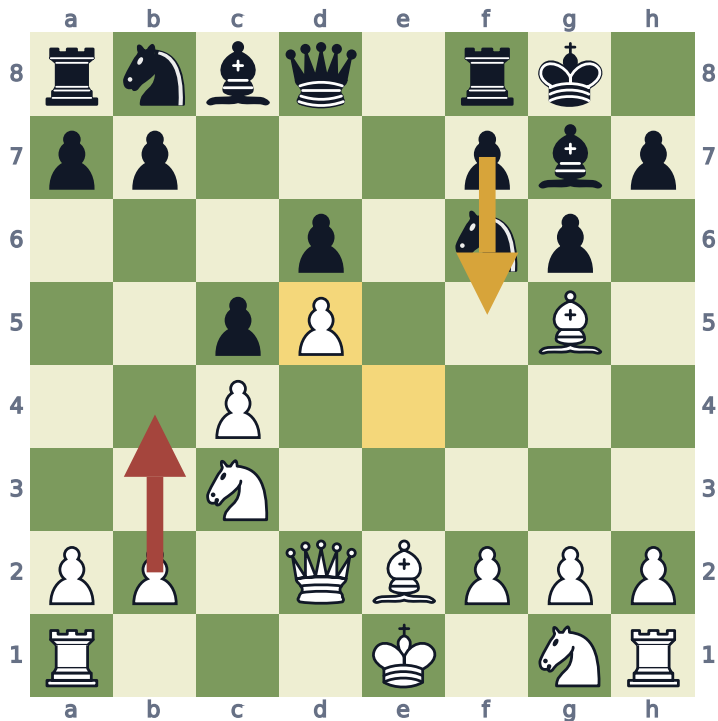
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FINAL SIDE TO MOVE

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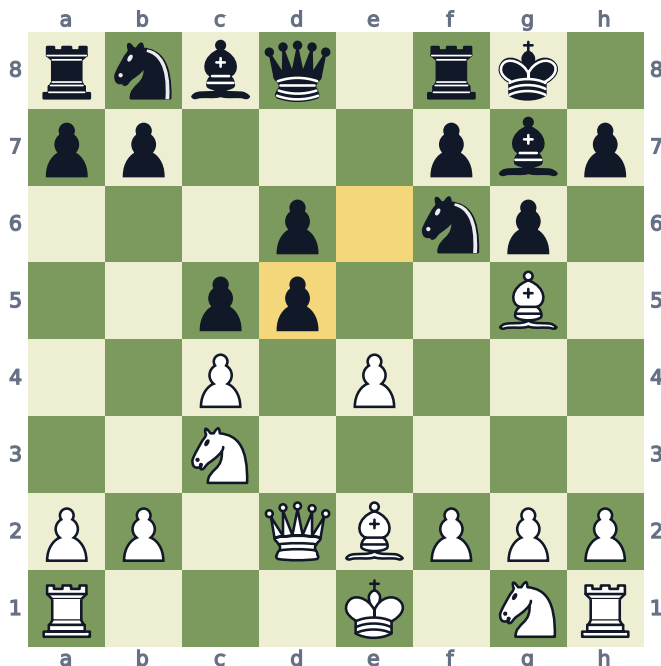
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- c5: Black attacks the center from the flank and invites a Benoni-like transformation.
- d5: White claims space or creates a break that changes Black's available time and squares.
- e6: Black changes the pawn skeleton; reassess breaks, open lines, and weakened squares.
- Qd2: White coordinates several plans, but the queen's safety and the opponent's forcing reply must be checked.
- exd5: Black changes the pawn skeleton; reassess breaks, open lines, and weakened squares.

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Bg5 restrains easy ...e5 and can discourage ...f5, so Black strikes with ...c5 before White consolidates.

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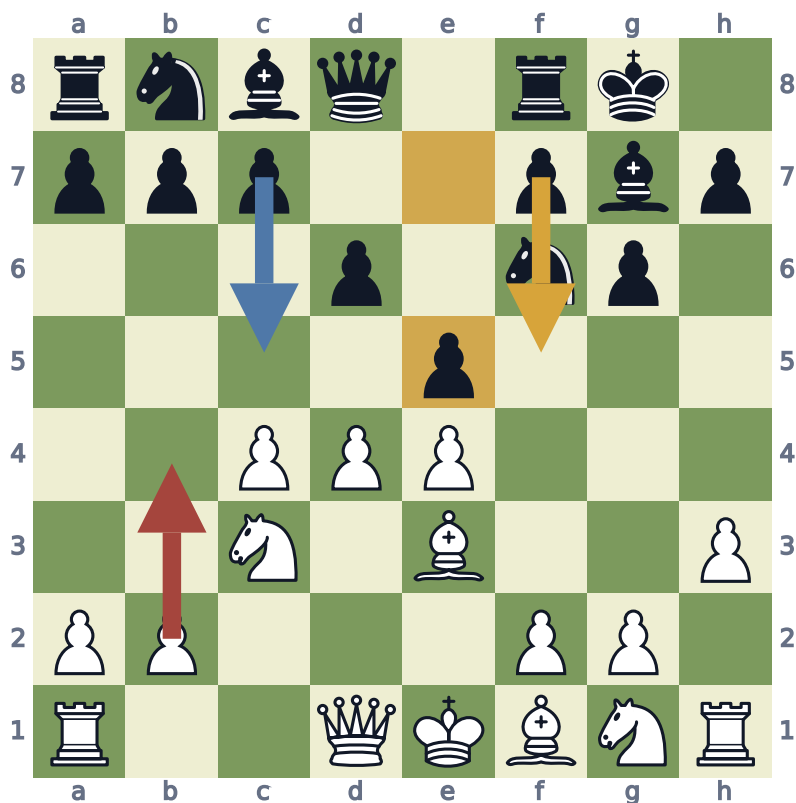
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BOARD RECONSTRUCTION

Rebuild the position after 16 plies from memory, then replay: 6. Bg5 c5 7. d5 e6 8. Qd2 exd5

DECODE PASS | STRUCTURAL DECISION POINT

Decode: Makogonov's h3 and g4



WHY THIS POSITION MATTERS

White prevents ...Ng4 and gains kingside space, but the pawn moves delay other development.

DECISION RULE

Choose counterplay based on the king's final location and the stability of e4.

SIDE TO MOVE

White

BLACK'S JOB

Use ...Na6-c5, restrain b4 with ...a5, and target the extended kingside later.

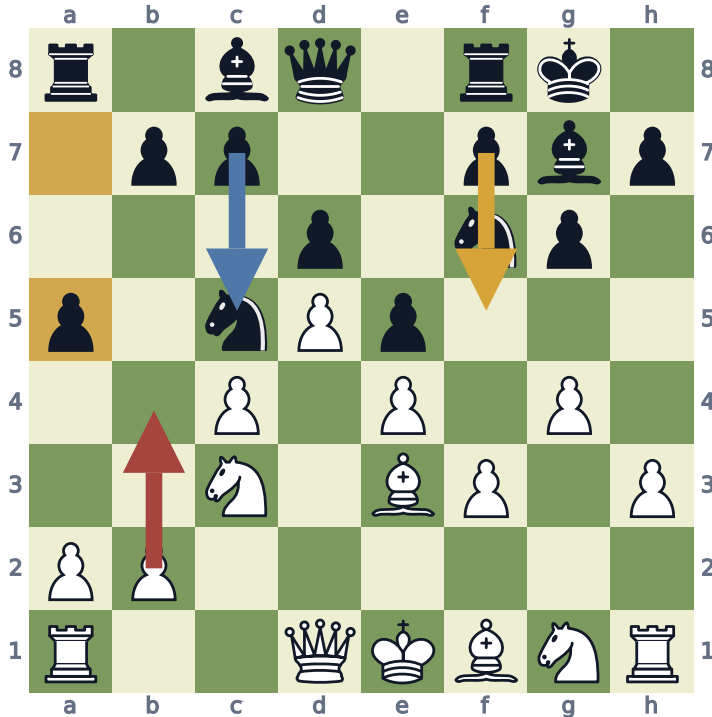
WHITE'S COUNTERPLAY

White supports g5, h4, and often queenside castling or a kingside space bind.

MEMORY RULE | Attack the base of the space, not the visible tip.

CUE -> REASON -> MOVE -> REPLY -> NEW POSITION

The plan map



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FINAL SIDE TO MOVE

White

WHITE'S BEST PRACTICAL IDEA

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FAILURE MODE

Reacting to every pawn push can leave Black without a central plan.

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Ask: Choose counterplay based on the king's final location and the stability of e4. Then compare at least two candidates against White's strongest forcing reply. Choose the endpoint whose center, king safety, and piece jobs you can explain.

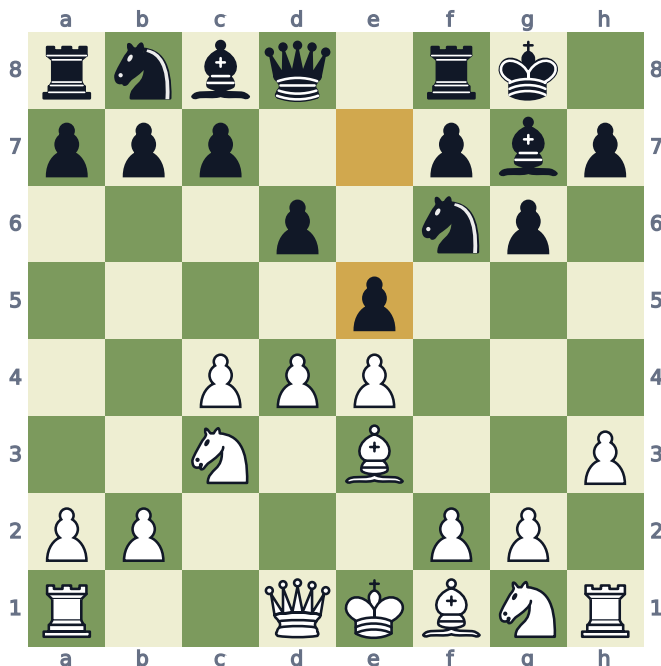
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Move-by-move meaning

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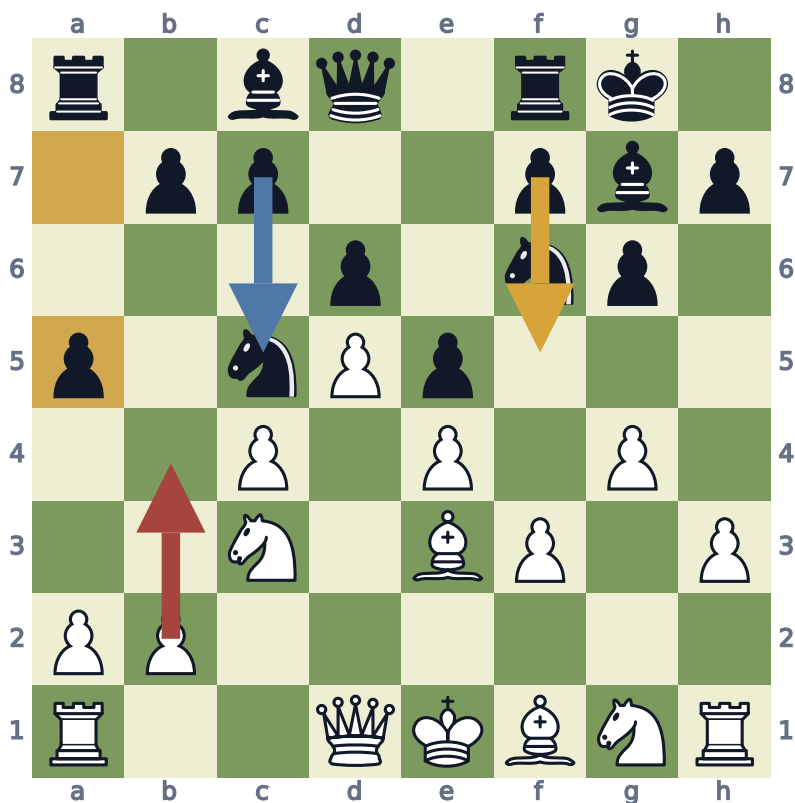
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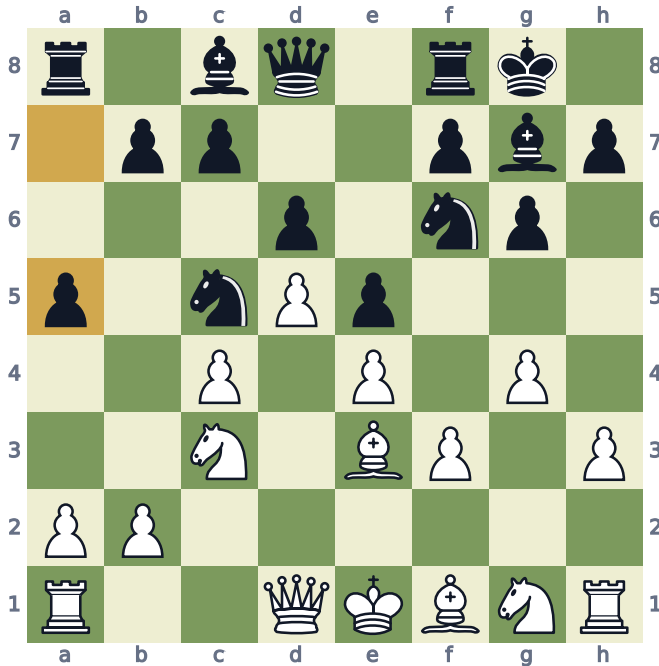
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- Na6: Black reroutes a knight toward a6; judge the move by its next square and immediate job.
- g4: White claims space or creates a break that changes Black's available time and squares.
- Nc5: Black reroutes a knight toward c5; judge the move by its next square and immediate job.
- f3: White changes the pawn skeleton; reassess breaks, open lines, and weakened squares.
- a5: Black changes the pawn skeleton; reassess breaks, open lines, and weakened squares.

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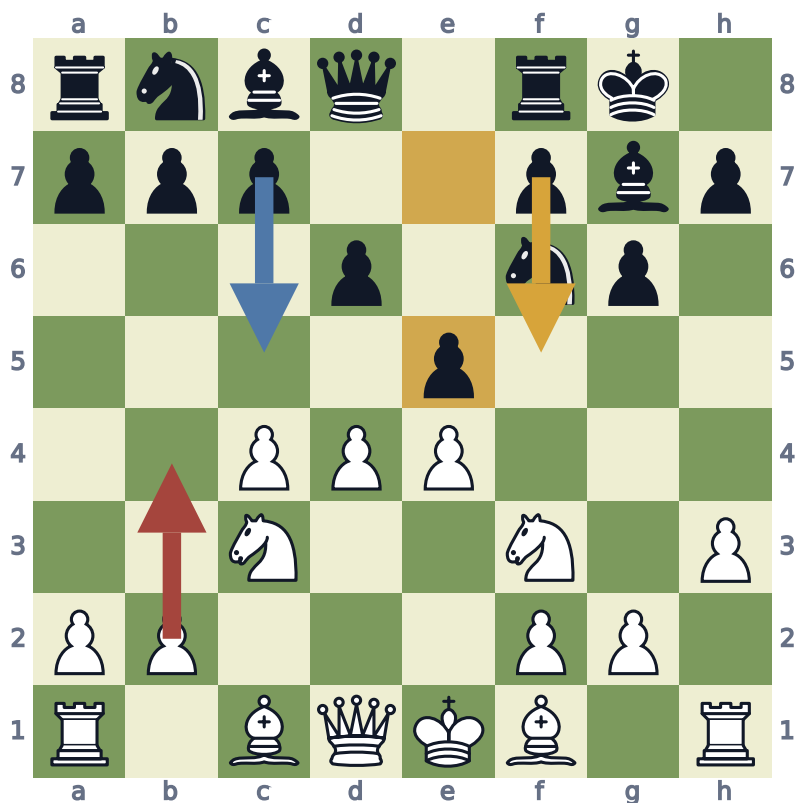
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BOARD RECONSTRUCTION

Rebuild the position after 18 plies from memory, then replay: 7. d5 Na6 8. g4 Nc5 9. f3 a5

DECODE PASS | STRUCTURAL DECISION POINT

Decode: The restrained classical center

**WHY THIS POSITION MATTERS**

With h3 included, White controls g4 and can develop the bishop freely, while Black gains time for queenside restraint.

DECISION RULE

Ask whether the first fight is for f5, c5, or the king's destination.

SIDE TO MOVE

White

BLACK'S JOB

Prepare ...Nd7, ...Nh7, or ...c6 and avoid committing the f-pawn without access.

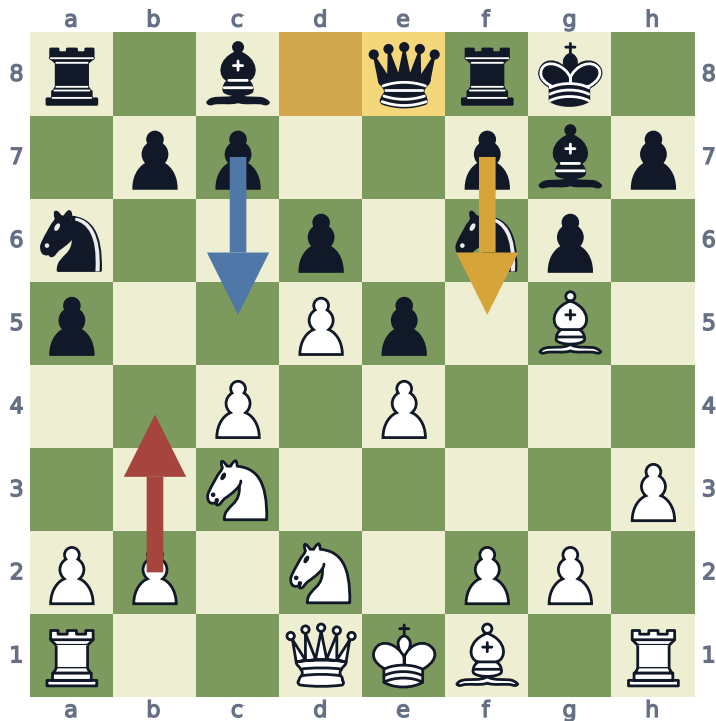
WHITE'S COUNTERPLAY

White seeks g4, Be2, and a later queenside break.

MEMORY RULE | A prevented maneuver is information: choose a different route.

CUE -> REASON -> MOVE -> REPLY -> NEW POSITION

The plan map



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FINAL SIDE TO MOVE

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Blindly forcing ...f5 can meet a prepared g4 clamp.

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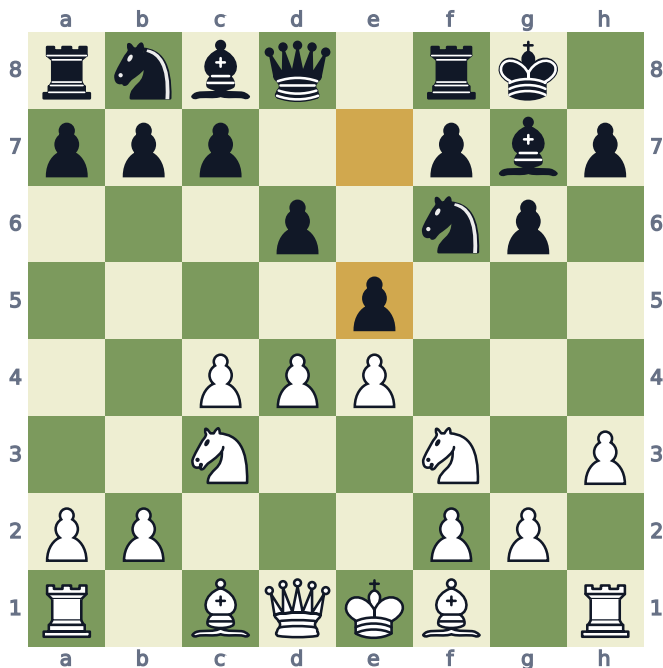
RULE | A prevented maneuver is information: choose a different route.

INSTRUCTIVE REFERENCE LINE - NOT A PROMISE OF FORCED BEST PLAY

Move-by-move meaning

REFERENCE LINE

1. d4 Nf6 2. c4 g6 3. Nc3 Bg7 4. e4 d6 5. h3 O-O 6. Nf3 e5 7. d5 a5 8. Bg5 Na6 9. Nd2 Qe8



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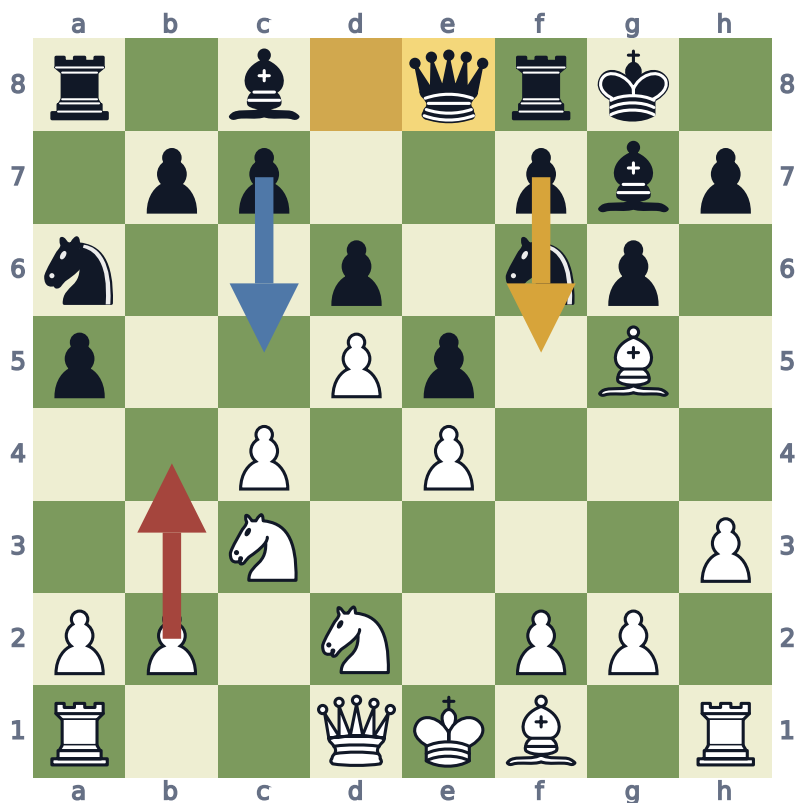
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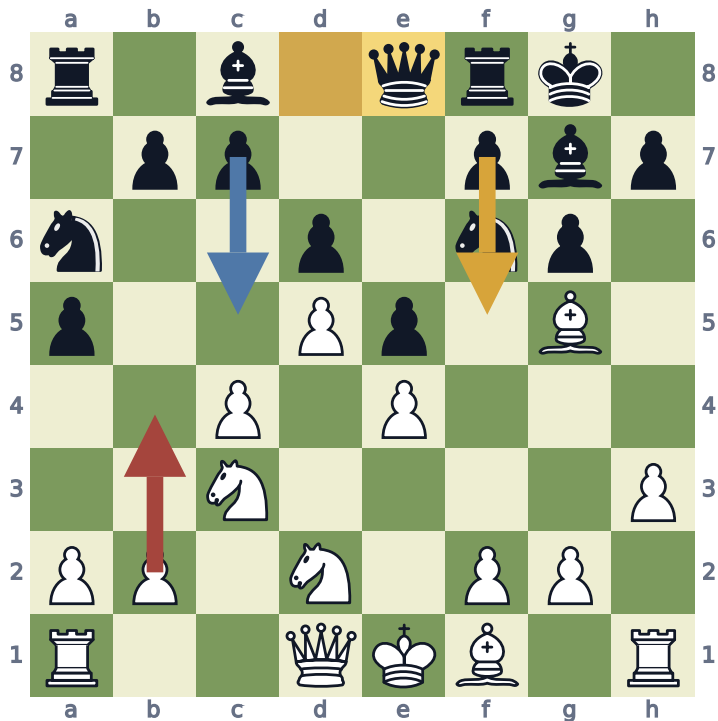
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SIX-POSITION TEST

Can you retrieve the plan without the chapter?

LESSON 055 Decode: The Averbakh bishop

Prompt: Decide whether the center should be opened before White castles.

Recall: When one break is restrained, test the other break immediately.

LESSON 056 Play: The Averbakh bishop

Prompt: Decide whether the center should be opened before White castles.

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LESSON 057 Decode: Makogonov's h3 and g4

Prompt: Choose counterplay based on the king's final location and the stability of e4.

Recall: Attack the base of the space, not the visible tip.

LESSON 058 Play: Makogonov's h3 and g4

Prompt: Choose counterplay based on the king's final location and the stability of e4.

Recall: Attack the base of the space, not the visible tip.

LESSON 059 Decode: The restrained classical center

Prompt: Ask whether the first fight is for f5, c5, or the king's destination.

Recall: A prevented maneuver is information: choose a different route.

LESSON 060 Play: The restrained classical center

Prompt: Ask whether the first fight is for f5, c5, or the king's destination.

Recall: A prevented maneuver is information: choose a different route.

PASS STANDARD

For each position: name the structure, Black's plan, White's counterplay, one candidate, the strongest reply, and the failure mode. Score one point each; 30 of 36 is a pass.

THREE SCENARIOS TO STORE

One-page repertoire memory sheet

CARD 1

The Averbakh bishop

1. d4 Nf6 2. c4 g6 3. Nc3 Bg7 4. e4 d6 5. Be2 O-O 6. Bg5 c5 7. d5 e6 8. Qd2 exd5 9. exd5

Decision: Decide whether the center should be opened before White castles.

Memory: When one break is restrained, test the other break immediately.

CARD 2

Makogonov's h3 and g4

1. d4 Nf6 2. c4 g6 3. Nc3 Bg7 4. e4 d6 5. h3 O-O 6. Be3 e5 7. d5 Na6 8. g4 Nc5 9. f3 a5

Decision: Choose counterplay based on the king's final location and the stability of e4.

Memory: Attack the base of the space, not the visible tip.

CARD 3

The restrained classical center

1. d4 Nf6 2. c4 g6 3. Nc3 Bg7 4. e4 d6 5. h3 O-O 6. Nf3 e5 7. d5 a5 8. Bg5 Na6 9. Nd2 Qe8

Decision: Ask whether the first fight is for f5, c5, or the king's destination.

Memory: A prevented maneuver is information: choose a different route.

Reconstruct each card from the final position, then from the opening moves alone.

SPACED RETRIEVAL AND GAME TRANSFER

Volume mastery tracker

Lesson	D1	D3	D7	D14	D30	Game	Pass
055 Decode: The Averbakh bishop	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
056 Play: The Averbakh bishop	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
057 Decode: Makogonov's h3 and g4	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
058 Play: Makogonov's h3 and g4	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
059 Decode: The restrained classical center	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
060 Play: The restrained classical center	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐

TWELVE-WEEK CYCLE

Weeks 1-2: decode the three structures. Weeks 3-4: replay all lines from memory. Weeks 5-7: solve the workbook pages. Weeks 8-10: test in slow games or against Fritz. Weeks 11-12: analyze failures and retest the volume examination.

PROMOTION RULE

Advance only when you can explain every memory rule, reproduce the three reference lines, name White's best counterplay, and show at least one analyzed game where the decision appeared.

Do not measure mastery by pages completed. Measure whether the correct questions appear during a real game.